



WORDPRESS PLUGIN · USER GUIDE

MBR Cookie Consent

Enterprise-grade consent management for WordPress — global privacy law coverage, script and embed blocking that survives a page cache, settings portability, and 22 community translations. Genuinely free.

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1. Introduction

MBR Cookie Consent is a complete, professional-grade consent management platform for WordPress — and it is entirely free. No premium tier, no upsells, no monthly fees, and no third-party branding forced onto your banner.

It was built on a simple frustration: privacy compliance had become something businesses were expected to pay hundreds of pounds a year for, often in exchange for a banner that displayed someone else's logo. This plugin takes the opposite view. Every feature you would expect from an enterprise consent platform is included in the free version, fully documented, and yours to configure however your site needs.

What this plugin does

- Displays a customisable, accessible consent banner that respects the visitor's choices.
- Blocks non-essential scripts and tracking until the visitor gives explicit consent.
- Adjusts automatically to the visitor's region, applying the correct privacy law.
- Integrates with Google Consent Mode v2 and Microsoft UET.
- Blocks form submissions server-side until consent is granted — even with JavaScript disabled.
- Keeps an exportable, audit-ready record of every consent interaction.
- Generates a privacy policy, including the AI training disclosure now required in Connecticut.
- Blocks click-to-play video facades created by performance plugins, and their poster images.
- Shows the banner in the visitor's own language, in 22 community-contributed translations.
- Works correctly behind a page cache, which most consent plugins quietly do not.
- Exports and imports its own configuration, so one tuned setup can be rolled out across many sites.
- Works across single sites and full WordPress Multisite networks.

New in version 2.3.3

This is the largest correctness release the plugin has had. It began as a single bug report about apostrophes and turned into a full review, so the notes below are longer than usual. Everything here is a fix or a removal rather than a new feature, and several of the faults were silent — the plugin appeared to be working while it was not.

Consent now survives a page cache

The most serious fault, and the reason this release matters. The plugin decided what to block by reading the visitor's consent cookie while building the page. On a site with a page cache — which is to say most sites — the first visitor to accept everything caused a fully unblocked copy of the page to be stored, and everybody served that copy afterwards got the trackers running whatever they themselves had chosen. Nothing in the browser could undo it, because by then the scripts were already in the page and had already run.

Google and Microsoft Consent Mode carried the same fault, reporting one visitor's consent as everyone's. Global Privacy Control carried it in the opposite direction: a single visitor with the signal enabled could cause every later visitor to be treated as having opted out, quietly suppressing marketing consent site-wide.

All three are fixed the same way. Every visitor is now served an identical page with everything held, and their own choice is applied in their browser. See section 22.

Video embeds behind a performance plugin

Performance plugins often replace a video embed with a click-to-play facade — a poster image and a placeholder, with the real player built only when the visitor clicks. No embed remained in the page for the consent layer to find, so

the video was never blocked while the site owner had every reason to believe it was. Facades are now recognised and held, along with their poster images, which were themselves contacting the video provider before consent. See section 9.

Other fixes

- **Quotes and apostrophes.** Text containing a quote gained extra backslashes on every save. Fixed, and existing damage is repaired automatically on update — except in Custom CSS, which has to be checked by hand.
- **Blocked inline scripts could delete page content.** Where a blocked pattern appeared in a later script on the page, everything between the two was silently removed. Only sites using a custom blocked script of type “inline” were affected.
- **Page exclusions could white-screen the site.** The setting stores a list but saves as text, and the mismatch was a fatal error on every front-end page load once the field had been used.
- **Consent logs recorded no method.** Every row said “other”, so the Method column — in a log kept as evidence of how consent was obtained — held nothing useful.
- **The network consent export was unsafe.** Visitor-supplied text was written to CSV unescaped, letting an unauthenticated visitor plant a formula that ran when a network administrator opened the file.

Removed

- **IAB TCF v2.3.** The feature never worked. It sent every vendor the same fixed consent string regardless of what the visitor had chosen, with a CMP ID of zero and an empty vendor list, so no vendor could act on it correctly — and a fixed signal claiming consent is worse than sending none at all. Supporting TCF properly requires registration as a Consent Management Platform with IAB Europe, which this plugin does not have. If you need TCF, you need a registered CMP.

Important

If you generated a privacy policy while IAB TCF was enabled, regenerate it. It stated that your site participates in the Transparency and Consent Framework, which was not accurate. Sites that had the option switched on receive a one-time notice explaining this.

Automatic translation now works

The banner can be shown in the visitor's own language, in 22 languages. This was previously advertised but did nothing whatever — the code that would have performed the translation was attached to a filter the plugin never called. The translations are community-contributed and must be reviewed by you before they are shown to anyone. See section 16.

Note

The number of supported languages was previously given as “40+”. It was 22, and it remains 22 — but all 22 are now complete across every string the banner displays, where before they covered roughly half, leaving visitors with a banner part in their language and part in English.

New in version 2.3.2

- **Glassmorphism, dark mode and a live preview.** A frosted-glass banner effect with opacity and blur controls, a dark mode that follows the visitor's system setting, and a Preview banner button that renders your unsaved changes. See section 6.
- **Live WCAG contrast readout.** The settings screen calculates the real contrast ratio for your chosen colours and opacity as you adjust them.

- **Media Library logo picker.** Choose the banner logo from your Media Library rather than pasting a URL.
- **Privacy policy Edit and Regenerate buttons.** Refresh a generated policy from your current settings without losing the page's title, URL or published status. See section 15.
- **WPML correction.** Banner text set in the plugin was being ignored on the front end when WPML was active. Your setting now wins in the site's default language — see section 16, as this may change what your site currently shows.

New in version 2.3.1

Version 2.3.1 was a security and hardening release following a full audit of the plugin's own code. No exploitation of any of the issues was reported — they were found by review. Two of them changed settings you may want to look at:

- **Visitor IP Detection.** Forwarding headers such as X-Forwarded-For are no longer trusted unconditionally, because any visitor could set one and choose which privacy regime they were shown. See section 12.
- **Geolocation over HTTPS.** Lookups no longer run over plain HTTP by default. Sites using ip-api.com without a pro key were moved to ipapi.co. See section 12.

The release also throttled the consent logging endpoint, validated category names, protected CSV exports against spreadsheet formula injection, widened IPv6 truncation in the consent log, restricted the cookie scanner to your own site, and removed the last use of eval() so script blocking works under a strict Content-Security-Policy. Notable fixes included subdomain consent sharing across .co.uk and other multi-part domains, A/B impressions being counted on every page load rather than once per visitor, and network button labels being stored as 1 instead of their text.

Good to know

Because the plugin is distributed directly from littlewebshack.com rather than the WordPress.org repository, you receive updates straight from the developer with no dependency on third-party review queues.

2. Requirements & Compatibility

MBR Cookie Consent is designed to run comfortably on standard WordPress hosting. Before installing, confirm your environment meets the minimums below.

Requirement	Minimum	Recommended
WordPress	5.8	6.5 or newer
PHP	7.4	8.1 or newer
MySQL / MariaDB	5.7 / 10.3	8.0 / 10.6 or newer
HTTPS	Strongly advised	Required for accurate consent records

Note

Earlier revisions of this guide listed WordPress 6.0 as the minimum. The plugin has always supported 5.8, and from version 2.3.2 the update manifest declares 5.8 as well. Before that the manifest asked for WordPress 6.0 and PHP 8.0, which meant sites on older versions were never offered an update at all — if a site of yours appears stuck on an old release, that is the likely reason, and updating once by hand will restore automatic updates.

Tested integrations

- **Page builders:** Elementor, plus the standard WordPress block editor.
- **Form plugins:** Contact Form 7, WPForms, Gravity Forms, Elementor Forms.
- **Multilingual:** WPML and Polylang.
- **Caching:** SiteGround Speed Optimizer, WP Rocket, LiteSpeed, W3 Total Cache, WP Super Cache, WP Fastest Cache, WP-Optimize, Cache Enabler, Breeze, Nginx Helper and WP Engine are purged automatically on save. See section 22.

Important

If you also run MBR WP Performance or another optimisation plugin that defers or delays JavaScript, read the note on script ordering in section 24 before going live. Consent scripts must load early enough to block trackers on the first view.

3. Installation & Activation

Installing the plugin

- Download the latest mbr-cookie-consent.zip from littlewebshack.com.
- In your WordPress admin, go to Plugins > Add New > Upload Plugin.
- Choose the downloaded ZIP file and select Install Now.
- When installation finishes, select Activate.

First activation

On activation the plugin creates its database tables for consent logging and registers a new admin menu, MBR Cookie Consent. A default banner configuration is applied immediately so your site is never left without a banner while you finish setting up. You can refine every part of that default in the steps that follow.

Tip

Updating from an earlier version is safe — your settings and consent records are preserved. Version 2.3.3 runs a one-off repair on text settings damaged by the escaping bug, and 2.3.0 deliberately left your existing regional behaviour untouched. Always take a routine backup before any plugin update, as you would with any change to a live site.

4. Quick Start: Compliant in Five Minutes

The following sequence gets a typical site to a compliant, working state quickly. Each step is expanded in its own section later in this guide.

Step 1 — Run the cookie scanner

Open MBR Cookie Consent > Scanner and run a one-click scan. The plugin crawls your pages and lists the scripts and iframes it finds, suggesting a category for each.

Step 2 — Confirm your categories

Review the detected items under Necessary, Analytics, Marketing and Preferences. Adjust any that were placed in the wrong category.

Step 3 — Set your region behaviour

Under Compliance, enable geolocation so visitors are shown the banner that matches their jurisdiction. Set a sensible default region while you are there — it is what visitors see if detection cannot resolve their location.

Step 4 — Style the banner

In Appearance, set your colours, choose your logo from the Media Library, and pick a layout. Use the Preview banner button to see the result at desktop and mobile widths before you save.

Step 5 — Publish and test

Save, then visit your site in a private browsing window. Confirm the banner appears, that rejecting consent blocks the relevant scripts, and that the floating revisit button reopens the preferences.

Note

Always test in a private / incognito window. A normal window may already hold a stored consent choice from earlier testing, which hides the banner and makes it look as though nothing is happening.

5. The Consent Banner

The banner is the visitor's first point of contact with your consent settings. It is designed to be clear, fast, and fully accessible.

Banner actions

Action	What it does
Accept All	Grants consent to every category and unblocks all scripts.
Reject All	Declines all non-essential categories; only necessary cookies run.
Customise	Opens the Preference Centre for category-by-category control.

Banner behaviour

- Until a choice is made, all non-essential scripts remain blocked by default.
- The visitor's choice is stored and respected on subsequent visits.
- A floating revisit button lets visitors reopen and change their choice at any time.
- Consent can be set to expire after a defined period, prompting re-confirmation.
- On HTTPS sites the consent cookie is marked Secure, so it is never sent in cleartext.

Important

Equal prominence between Accept and Reject is a requirement under several jurisdictions, including the EU and UK. The default banner gives Accept All and Reject All buttons of equal weight — avoid restyling one to be far more prominent than the other.

6. Banner Customisation

The Appearance area lets you make the banner look like a natural part of your site rather than a bolt-on. A live preview reflects each change as you make it.

What you can change

Option	Details
Layout	Choose the banner position and shape — for example a bottom bar, a corner box, or a centred modal.
Colours	Set background, text, button and accent colours to match your brand.
Custom text	Rewrite the banner heading, body copy and button labels in your own voice.
Logo	Choose an image from the Media Library, with a live preview and a Remove button, or paste a URL for a logo hosted elsewhere.
Glassmorphism	A frosted-glass effect for the banner, with Opacity and Blur sliders.
Dark mode	Off, follow the visitor's system setting, or always on.

Choosing a logo

The Choose from Media Library button sits above the URL field. Where WordPress has generated sizes for the image, the medium size is used rather than the full original — so a large upload is not sent to every visitor merely to be displayed at 150 pixels wide. Pasting a URL directly still works for logos hosted elsewhere.

Glassmorphism and dark mode

The glass effect applies to the banner only. The Preference Centre is a dense, scrollable panel of category toggles and body copy, where translucency fights the reading rather than decorating it, so it stays on a solid surface — in dark mode too. Browsers without backdrop-filter support fall back to the solid colour automatically, as do visitors who have asked their system for reduced transparency.

Dark mode swaps only the banner surface and text. Your Accept and Reject button colours are kept, so your branding survives the switch.

The contrast readout

Beside the glassmorphism sliders is a live WCAG 2.1 contrast ratio. Rather than capping how transparent the banner may be, the settings screen composites your chosen banner colour, text colour and opacity over both a white and a black backdrop, and reports the worse of the two. If that figure passes, the banner is legible over any page behind it — which a fixed opacity limit cannot guarantee. The reading updates as you move the sliders or change either colour.

Previewing before you save

The Preview banner button opens the banner in a modal using the settings currently on screen, including unsaved changes, at both desktop and mobile widths. The preview is produced by the real front-end renderer rather than a separate mock-up, so it cannot drift from what visitors actually see, and it runs inside an iframe so the banner's stylesheet cannot affect the admin page around it.

Important

If you had quotes in your Custom CSS before version 2.3.3, check that field after updating. The escaping bug fixed in that release added backslashes to quoted text on every save, and Custom CSS is deliberately excluded from the automatic repair — CSS uses backslashes as genuine escape characters, so there is no safe way to tell one you wrote from one the bug created.

Tip

Whatever colours you choose, keep text and buttons at a contrast ratio that meets WCAG 2.1 AA (at least 4.5:1 for normal text). The readout beside the sliders does this for you — treat anything below 4.5:1 as a problem to fix rather than a warning to dismiss.

7. Cookie Categories & the Preference Centre

Cookies and scripts are organised into four standard categories. The Preference Centre is where visitors turn each category on or off individually.

Category	Purpose	Blocked by default?
Necessary	Essential for the site to function; cannot be switched off.	No — always allowed
Analytics	Measurement and statistics, e.g. Google Analytics.	Yes
Marketing	Advertising and cross-site tracking.	Yes
Preferences	Remembering choices such as language or region.	Yes

The Preference Centre

- Each non-necessary category has a clear on/off control.
- A short description explains what each category is for, in plain language.
- Visitors can accept some categories and decline others, then save.
- Choices take effect immediately — scripts in declined categories stay blocked.

8. Cookie Scanner & Script Management

One-click scanning

The scanner crawls your site and detects the scripts and iframes that set cookies or load third-party resources. Each detected item is listed with a suggested category, ready for you to confirm or change.

Manual management

- Add a script or pattern by hand if the scanner cannot reach it (for example, scripts loaded only after login).
- Edit the category or matching rule for any detected item.
- Remove items you no longer use.

Note

From version 2.3.1 the scanner runs only against your own site, or the network on multisite, and verifies TLS certificates. It can no longer be pointed at an arbitrary URL. Run it again whenever you add a new third-party service — a new analytics tag, chat widget, embedded video, or advertising pixel. Newly added trackers are not blocked until the plugin knows about them.

9. Automatic Script Blocking

This is the engine behind genuine compliance. Rather than simply hiding a banner, the plugin actively prevents non-essential scripts from running until the visitor has given consent for the relevant category.

How it works

- Every visitor is served the same page, with all non-necessary scripts and embeds held inert.
- The browser then releases whatever the visitor's stored choice permits.
- If consent is declined, those scripts never run, and no cookies they would set are written.
- Necessary scripts are never blocked, so core site functionality is unaffected.

Why the page is always blocked

Until version 2.3.3 the plugin decided what to block while building the page, by reading the visitor's consent cookie. That cannot be made safe on a cached site: the first visitor to accept everything caused an unblocked copy of the page to be stored, and everyone served that copy afterwards got the trackers running whatever they had chosen themselves.

Blocking now happens for everybody, without reference to any cookie, so the page is identical for every visitor and safe for a cache to store. The consequence worth knowing about is that a visitor who has accepted has their scripts released a moment after the page arrives rather than as it is parsed. This is how every mature consent platform works, and it is the only arrangement that is correct behind a cache.

Click-to-play video facades

Performance plugins commonly replace a video embed with a facade: a poster image and a placeholder holding the video address, with the real player built in JavaScript only when the visitor clicks. It is a good optimisation, and before 2.3.3 it defeated consent blocking entirely — there was no embed left in the page to hold, so the video loaded regardless of what the visitor had chosen.

Facades are now recognised and held in the same way as an ordinary embed, and released by the browser on consent. MBR Performance, SG Optimizer, WP Rocket and others are covered, since the plugin matches the technique rather than any one product.

Good to know

Poster images are held too. A facade avoids the video provider's cookies but still fetches its thumbnail, which sent the visitor's IP address to YouTube or Vimeo on page load whether or not they ever pressed play. A transparent placeholder stands in until consent, so the layout does not move.

Important

If you run a performance plugin with a video lazy-load or facade option, test an embed after updating: reject cookies and confirm the video is replaced by the blocked-content placeholder. This was a silent failure, so it is worth seeing it work rather than assuming.

Good to know

Because blocking happens before trackers fire, no analytics or advertising cookies are written ahead of consent. This is the behaviour regulators in the EU and UK expect, and it is the default here rather than an optional extra. Since version 2.3.1 the restore step no longer uses `eval()`, so blocking also works under a Content-Security-Policy without `'unsafe-eval'`.

10. Consent Mode Integration

For sites that use Google or Microsoft advertising and analytics, MBR Cookie Consent speaks their consent signalling languages directly, so your tags adjust their behaviour according to the visitor's choices.

Framework	What it covers
Google Consent Mode v2	Signals <code>ad_storage</code> , <code>analytics_storage</code> and the v2 ad-personalisation parameters to Google tags.
Microsoft UET Consent Mode	Passes consent state to the Microsoft Advertising Universal Event Tracking tag.
Google Additional Consent	Manages consent for Google Ad Tech Providers, for sites using Google advertising products.

Setting it up

- Enable the relevant framework under MBR Cookie Consent > Consent Mode.
- Ensure your Google or Microsoft tags load through the plugin's blocking layer so the signals apply.
- Use Google Tag Assistant or the Microsoft UET Tag Helper to confirm the consent state is being received.

Note

Consent Mode changes how tags behave; it does not remove the need for the banner. Keep both enabled — the banner gathers the choice, Consent Mode acts on it.

How the signal is sent

The page always declares a denied default, identical for every visitor, and the visitor's actual choice is sent as an update from their browser before any Google or Microsoft tag loads. This is what the Consent Mode specification asks for — the default establishes the pre-consent baseline and the update carries the decision — and it is also the only arrangement that survives a page cache.

Before 2.3.3 the default itself was written from the visitor's cookie, so on a cached site Google and Microsoft were told that visitors had consented when they had not. If you use either platform, this release is worth installing for that reason alone.

Important

IAB TCF v2.3 was removed in 2.3.3. It never functioned: every vendor received the same fixed consent string regardless of what the visitor chose. Supporting TCF properly requires registration as a Consent Management Platform with IAB Europe. If you are a publisher running programmatic advertising and need TCF, you need a registered CMP — this plugin covers GDPR, UK, CCPA and the other regimes in section 13, none of which require it.

11. Form Builder Integration

This is the feature that sets MBR Cookie Consent apart. Most plugins block forms with JavaScript alone, which anyone can bypass by disabling JavaScript. This plugin enforces consent on the server.

Server-side enforcement

When a visitor submits a form before granting the required consent, the submission is intercepted on the server and held. Because the check happens server-side, it cannot be circumvented by turning off JavaScript or editing the page.

Supported builders

- Contact Form 7
- WPForms
- Gravity Forms
- Elementor Forms

The Elementor experience

- A clean dark overlay modal replaces inline error messages.
- The visitor is offered Accept Cookies or Not Now.
- On acceptance, the pending submission is re-sent automatically with all entered data intact — the visitor does not have to retype anything.

Configuration

- Choose which consent category a form requires before it will submit.
- Customise the message shown when a submission is blocked.

Tip

The automatic re-submission relies on capturing the original request so it can be replayed after consent. If you use a heavily customised form setup, test the full submit-block-accept-resubmit cycle before launch.

12. Geolocation & Regional Compliance

Different regions demand different consent models. Geolocation lets a single configuration serve the right experience to each visitor automatically.

Model	Typical regions	Banner behaviour
Opt-in	EU / EEA, United Kingdom, Switzerland, Quebec, Brazil, India, Vietnam, Indonesia, Nigeria, China, South Korea, Saudi Arabia, South Africa	Scripts blocked until the visitor actively accepts.
Opt-out	Much of the United States	Scripts may run, with a clear way to opt out / 'Do Not Sell'.
Notice	Canada (federal), Australia	Visitors are informed; behaviour follows local rules.

- Enable geolocation under Compliance to detect the visitor's region.
- The plugin then applies the appropriate model without you maintaining separate banners.
- You can override behaviour for specific regions if your legal advice requires it.

Visitor IP Detection

Introduced in version 2.3.1. Working out a visitor's country starts with working out their IP address, and behind a proxy or CDN that means reading a forwarding header. The difficulty is that any visitor can send those headers themselves. Trusting them blindly meant a visitor could nominate their own IP address and so choose which privacy regime they were shown — and could mint unlimited distinct addresses, each creating its own cache entry and its own outbound lookup.

Mode	When to use it
Automatic (default)	Accepts Cloudflare's header only when the request genuinely arrived from a Cloudflare address. Cloudflare sites work with no configuration.
Trusted proxies	You sit behind a known load balancer or CDN. Supply its addresses and only those are believed.
Direct	No proxy in front of the site. The connecting address is used and forwarding headers are ignored entirely.

Lookup provider and HTTPS

Also from 2.3.1, geolocation lookups no longer run over plain HTTP by default. ip-api.com serves HTTPS only on its paid tier, and over plain HTTP anyone able to observe the connection can rewrite the country returned — silently changing which privacy regime your visitors receive — while their IP addresses travel to a third party unencrypted. Sites using ip-api.com without a pro key were moved to ipapi.co, which is free over HTTPS, and a dismissible notice explained the change. ip-api.com remains available with a pro key, or via an explicit opt-in for anyone who wants its higher free rate limit and accepts the trade-off.

The default region changed in 2.3.0

Every country without a dedicated region falls back to a single Rest of World setting. Until version 2.3.0 that fallback allowed implied consent, including accepting on scroll. That was too lenient: several countries that land there genuinely require opt-in consent. From 2.3.0 the Rest of World default is opt-in — no auto-accept, and a reject option always present.

Important

Existing sites were not changed by that update. The plugin wrote your previous Rest of World behaviour into your settings explicitly, so your banner continued to behave exactly as it did. Only brand-new installations start with the stricter default. You can change it either way under Compliance at any time.

How detection is cached

- A detected region is remembered per visitor IP address for 24 hours by default, so repeat visits do not trigger a fresh lookup each time.
- If the lookup provider is unreachable, rate-limited or blocked by your host, the plugin falls back to the default region you configured.
- From version 2.2.1 that fallback is remembered for only a few minutes rather than the full period, so a temporary provider problem clears itself instead of persisting for a day.
- From version 2.3.1 outbound lookups are capped per minute, so a traffic burst with cold caches cannot trip the provider's rate limit and leave every visitor on the fallback.
- Set your default region to the one that matches most of your audience — it is what visitors see whenever detection cannot resolve a location.

Important

Geolocation tells you where a visitor appears to be; it is not legal advice. If you operate in a regulated sector or are unsure which model applies to you, confirm your obligations with a qualified adviser.

13. Privacy Law Reference

As of July 2026, MBR Cookie Consent is built to help you meet the requirements of the major privacy regimes below. This table is a plain-language summary, not a statement of legal compliance for your specific circumstances.

Law / framework	Region	Consent model
GDPR	EU / EEA	Prior opt-in for non-essential cookies
UK DUAA	United Kingdom	Opt-in, handled separately from EU GDPR
CCPA / CPRA	California, USA	Opt-out, with 'Do Not Sell or Share'
US state laws	24 states enacted, 20 in effect	Opt-out, varying by state
Quebec Law 25	Quebec, Canada	Express opt-in, French-language banner
revFADP	Switzerland	Opt-in, GDPR-equivalent
LGPD	Brazil	Opt-in for non-essential cookies
India DPDP Act	India	Notice and consent for personal data
Vietnam PDPL	Vietnam	Opt-in, granular per-purpose consent
Indonesia UU PDP	Indonesia	Opt-in, purpose-specific with easy withdrawal
Nigeria NDPA + GAID	Nigeria	Opt-in, prominent banner required
China PIPL	China	Opt-in; separate consent for transfers
South Korea PIPA	South Korea	Opt-in where cookies identify a person
Saudi Arabia PDPL	Saudi Arabia	Opt-in; consent is the default basis
South Africa POPIA	South Africa	Opt-in for direct marketing
Global Privacy Control	Browser-level signal	Honoured automatically as an opt-out

Important

China needs work beyond the banner. PIPL requires a separate, standalone consent for transferring personal information outside mainland China, plus an approved transfer mechanism. This plugin provides neither. If you have meaningful traffic from mainland China, treat the China region as a starting point and take advice on the transfer requirements.

Recently updated: United States

Connecticut's amended privacy act took effect on 1 July 2026 and reaches considerably further than before. The threshold for being covered dropped sharply, and it disappears entirely for any business that processes sensitive data or sells personal data — so a small site can now be in scope. Sensitive data was widened to include neural data, government identifiers, financial account details and social security numbers. A further Connecticut package follows on 1 October 2026.

Connecticut also introduced the AI training disclosure covered in the next section. Separately, Arkansas introduced a children and teens' privacy law on the same date, which bans targeted advertising to minors outright.

Note

This plugin does not provide age assurance or age gating. If your site is directed at children or teenagers, the minors' provisions in Arkansas and several other states need to be handled outside the consent banner.

Global Privacy Control (GPC)

GPC is a signal sent by the visitor's browser indicating a blanket opt-out of sale or sharing. The plugin reads this signal and treats it as a valid opt-out where the law recognises it, without the visitor needing to interact with the banner at all.

Good to know

Regional rules move constantly. The plugin's compliance notes are reviewed and refreshed with each release, so keeping up to date is the simplest way to stay current — there is nothing to reconfigure when a region's guidance changes.

14. AI & Model Training Disclosure

Connecticut is the first US state to require your privacy notice to say plainly whether personal data is collected, used or sold to train large language models. The plugin gives you a simple way to answer that question accurately.

What the law asks

The requirement is short but demanding. To answer it truthfully you need to know three things: whether your own products train or fine-tune models on user data, whether any of your suppliers are permitted to use your data to improve their models, and whether you sell or license data to anyone building AI systems. A vague line about using data to improve services does not answer it.

Configuring the disclosure

- Open MBR Cookie Consent > Settings > Advanced Consent and find AI / LLM Training Disclosure.
- Tick the first box to include the section in your generated privacy policy.
- Then tick any of the three statements that apply to you — your own models, your vendors' models, or selling data into training datasets.
- Add an optional sentence of extra detail if it helps explain your position.
- Regenerate your privacy policy page so the new text appears — see section 15.

What gets written

If none of the three statements apply, the plugin writes a clear statement that you do not collect, use or sell personal data to train large language models. That is the correct answer for most sites, and it is worth stating plainly rather than staying silent. If any do apply, each one produces a short paragraph explaining it in plain language.

Important

Check before you tick. An inaccurate statement in a public privacy notice is not only a privacy law problem — it can also be treated as a deceptive business practice. The answer about vendors in particular usually requires reading your suppliers' terms, because many reserve the right to use customer data for model improvement by default.

Note

These settings are deliberately excluded from settings export and import. They drive a legal statement about your business's data practices, and carrying them to another site would publish a claim nobody there ever made. See section 21.

15. Privacy Policy & Cookie Policy Pages

The plugin can generate both a cookie policy and a privacy policy from your current settings, including the AI training disclosure. Both appear as cards on the Dashboard once created.

Generating and editing

- Use the Generate button on the Dashboard to create the page.
- Once a page exists, Edit opens it directly in the WordPress editor.
- Regenerate rewrites the content from your current settings.

What Regenerate does and does not touch

Regenerating rewrites only the page content. The title, URL, published status and author are left alone, so a published policy stays published at the same address — no broken links, and nothing silently reverts to draft. The previous version is saved as a revision first, so it can be recovered from the page editor if you need it back.

Good to know

Before version 2.3.2 the Generate button disappeared once the page had been created, leaving no way to refresh the policy from the plugin when your settings changed. If you have been editing a generated policy by hand for that reason, review it before regenerating — your manual edits will be replaced by the generated text, though the previous version remains available as a revision.

Note

An existing policy page is never rewritten automatically. If you change a setting that affects the policy — the AI training disclosure being the common one — you must regenerate the page for the new text to appear.

16. Internationalisation & Community Translations

The banner can be shown in the visitor's own language, in 22 languages. Because a consent notice is a legal statement rather than ordinary interface text, this works differently from most translation features — nothing is shown to a visitor until you have read it and approved it.

This did not work before 2.3.3

It is worth being plain about this. Earlier versions advertised automatic translation in 40+ languages. There were 22 languages, they covered about half the strings the banner displays, and none of them were ever shown to anybody: the code that would have performed the translation was attached to an internal hook the plugin never triggered. The setting had no effect whichever way it was set. If you had it switched on, your visitors saw your own wording throughout.

All 22 languages are now complete across every string, and the feature genuinely works.

Why the translations need your approval

The translations are contributed rather than professionally produced, and they have not been checked by a qualified translator or a lawyer. A cookie banner tells visitors what you collect and what they are agreeing to. An approximate translation of ordinary interface text is a minor annoyance; an approximate translation of a consent notice is a compliance risk, and it is your site that carries it.

So nothing is served automatically. Each language has to be read and approved individually, and until it is, visitors asking for that language see your own wording — which is text you wrote and can stand behind.

Reviewing and approving a language

- Open MBR Cookie Consent › Translations for the list of available languages and their status.
- Select Review beside a language to see every string with your English beside the translation.
- Read it. Right-to-left languages are displayed in the correct direction.
- Tick the confirmation and select Approve. The confirmation is required — approval is refused without it.
- Enable Auto-Translation under Settings once at least one language is approved.

Approval can be withdrawn at any time, and takes effect immediately.

Tip

Approve the languages you or a colleague can actually read, and leave the rest. Six approved languages covering most of your traffic is a better position than twenty-two nobody has checked, and the unapproved ones cost you nothing — those visitors simply see your own wording.

Your own wording is never overwritten

If you have rewritten a string — your own banner heading, say, rather than the one the plugin ships — it is never replaced by a translation. There is no community translation of your wording, and showing your actual words in English is more accurate than showing a generic sentence in French that says something subtly different. Customised strings are marked as such on the review screen, so you are not asked to approve text that will not be used.

How the language is chosen

The visitor's browser language settings are used, taking the first of their preferred languages that you have approved. Regional variants share a language: a visitor asking for Brazilian Portuguese is served the Portuguese translation, since these are generic consent notices rather than regionally specific text.

The swap happens in the browser, not on the server. Choosing a language while building the page would write one visitor's language into a copy that a cache then serves to everybody — the same fault described in section 22. If anything prevents the swap, the page simply stays in your own wording.

Available languages

Region	Languages
Western Europe	French, German, Spanish, Italian, Portuguese, Dutch
Northern Europe	Swedish, Danish, Norwegian, Finnish
Central & Eastern Europe	Polish, Czech, Russian, Greek
Asia	Japanese, Chinese, Korean, Thai, Vietnamese
Middle East	Arabic, Hebrew, Turkish

Contributing a correction

The translations are plain JSON files, one per language, in the languages/banner folder of the plugin and in the GitHub repository. If you are a native speaker and something reads awkwardly, a correction is genuinely welcome — that is what community-maintained means, and it is the mechanism by which these improve.

WPML and Polylang

- Full string registration for WPML and Polylang, unchanged by the above.
- Your custom banner text is translatable through the same workflow as the rest of your site.
- Saving your settings refreshes the registered strings, so multilingual copies do not go stale.

Where a multilingual plugin is active it takes precedence for its own languages, since it varies the page address and is therefore safe to apply while building the page. Community translations fill in for visitors whose language your multilingual setup does not cover.

Which wording wins, and where

Version 2.3.2 corrected a long-standing fault. Banner text set in the plugin was ignored on the front end when WPML was active: the plugin asked WPML for the string by name, and WPML returned the copy it had registered when the string was first seen, discarding the updated value passed alongside it. The setting saved, the admin field showed the new wording, and the front end silently kept the old.

In your site's default language, the plugin's own setting is now authoritative. Secondary languages still come from WPML or Polylang as before.

Important

If you previously worked around the old behaviour by editing your default-language wording in WPML's String Translation screen, the plugin's setting will now override it. Sites running WPML or Polylang get a one-time notice explaining this. Check your banner in the default language after updating, and move any wording you want to keep into the plugin's own settings.

Good to know

Version 2.x defers translation loading to the point of use, which resolves the `'_load_textdomain_just_in_time'` notice introduced in WordPress 6.7. If you previously saw that notice, updating clears it.

17. Accessibility

The banner and Preference Centre are built to WCAG 2.1 AA so that consent is genuinely available to every visitor, not just those using a mouse.

- Full keyboard navigation throughout the banner and Preference Centre.
- Screen reader support with appropriate ARIA roles and labels.
- A focus trap keeps keyboard focus within the modal while it is open.
- Visible focus indicators so keyboard users always know where they are.
- Visitors who have asked their system for reduced transparency are served a solid banner surface rather than the glass effect.

Tip

If you heavily restyle the banner colours, re-check contrast afterwards. Accessibility is built in, but custom colours are your responsibility to keep within AA contrast ratios — the live readout described in section 6 is the quickest way to confirm it.

18. Consent Logging & Records of Consent

Being able to demonstrate consent is as important as collecting it. The plugin keeps a record of every consent interaction.

- Each interaction is logged with its timestamp and the categories chosen.
- IP addresses are anonymised in line with GDPR data-handling expectations. IPv6 addresses are truncated by 80 bits, which from version 2.3.1 removes enough of the address to prevent a household being identified.
- Records are exportable to CSV for your own audit and retention processes.
- Old records can be pruned on demand; the plugin asks for confirmation first and refuses a retention period below one day.

Good to know

The logging endpoint accepts unauthenticated requests by design, because a nonce baked into cached HTML goes stale and would block genuine consent records. Since 2.3.1 it is throttled per visitor so the log cannot be flooded with junk rows, and category names are validated against the categories your site has actually registered. CSV exports are also protected against spreadsheet formula injection, since a value beginning with `=`, `+`, `-` or `@` is executed as a formula by Excel, LibreOffice and Sheets.

Important

Consent records written before version 2.3.3 have an unreliable Method column. Every row was recorded as “other”, because the values the banner sends were missing from the list the server accepted. The categories, timestamps and everything else in those rows are sound — only the Method column is affected — but it cannot be reconstructed. Rows written from 2.3.3 onward record the method correctly.

Important

Consent records are personal data. Store any exports securely, keep them only as long as you need them, and include them in your own data retention and deletion routines. They are deliberately excluded from the settings export described in section 21, and are never removed by a plugin update, by deactivation, or even by deleting the plugin — removing that data is always a deliberate act on your part.

19. A/B Testing

A/B testing lets you compare two banner variations to see which earns clearer, higher-quality consent. Define an alternative variant, and the plugin serves the two versions to different visitors so you can compare outcomes.

- Test wording, layout or button styling against each other.
- Compare acceptance behaviour between the two variants.
- Adopt the stronger performer once you have enough data.

Important

Statistics gathered before version 2.3.1 are overstated. Impressions were counted on every page load rather than once per visitor, so a single visitor reloading a page inflated the count each time. Conversions are now deduplicated per visitor over 24 hours. Reset your existing statistics before drawing any conclusions from them.

Note

Optimise for clarity and informed choice, not for the highest possible Accept rate. A banner engineered purely to maximise acceptance can undermine the validity of the consent you collect.

20. Multisite Support

On a WordPress Multisite network, MBR Cookie Consent is network-aware and adjusts its settings across sites automatically.

- Activate across the network, or per individual site, as you prefer.
- Apply a consistent baseline configuration to every site on the network.
- Allow individual sites to keep their own settings where they differ.
- New sites added to the network pick up the network configuration automatically.

Note

Network settings are shared, but page caches are not — each site holds its own. Saving network settings purges the cache of the site you saved from; other sites pick the change up as their own caches expire, or immediately if an administrator saves there. See section 22.

Tip

For separate installs that are not part of a Multisite network, use the settings export and import described in the next section to keep their configuration aligned.

21. Importing & Exporting Settings

Settings import and export lets you configure one site exactly as you want it, then reproduce that configuration on any number of other installs — without re-keying a single field. It was built for multi-site rollouts and for keeping a repeatable, auditable baseline.

Exporting a configuration

- Go to MBR Cookie Consent > Import / Export.
- Select Download settings file.
- A single JSON file is produced, named after your site and the date.
- The file carries a short header — plugin version, source site, timestamp and an integrity checksum — alongside the settings themselves.

What travels with the file

Category	Detail
Included	Banner appearance and text, glassmorphism opacity and blur, dark mode, the logo URL, banner behaviour, cookie categories, blocked scripts, Google and Microsoft Consent Mode, GPC, form integration, page exclusions, custom CSS, subdomain sharing, policy link toggles and URLs, and all geolocation regional headings and descriptions.
Never included	Consent logs. These are visitor personal data and stay with the site that collected them — use the CSV export on the Consent Logs screen instead.
Site-local, excluded	Policy page IDs, the geolocation lookup cache, version markers, the logo's Media Library attachment ID, the visitor IP detection mode and trusted proxy list, the ip-api.com pro key, the plain-HTTP geolocation opt-in, the AI training disclosure settings, and the list of approved community translations.

Why those exclusions matter

Each excluded value is a fact about one specific site rather than a preference you would want to reproduce. An attachment ID refers to a different image, or none at all, on another install. Which proxy a site sits behind is a property of that server, and importing it elsewhere can silently break geolocation. A credential should not ride along in a file that gets emailed around, and a security opt-in should never switch itself on as a side effect of importing someone else's configuration. An approved translation records that a particular person read that language and took responsibility for publishing it, which is not a responsibility that transfers with a settings file. Agencies templating many sites for one client can opt any of these back in with the `mbr_cc_site_local_settings` filter.

Importing on another site

- On the destination site, open the same screen and choose the file.
- Tick the confirmation box, then select Import settings.
- Matching settings are overwritten. A short report shows how many were applied and whether anything was ignored.
- Regional banner text imports correctly even onto a brand-new site that has never had geolocation configured.
- Your page cache is purged automatically once the import completes.

Undoing an import

- Before an import is applied, the plugin automatically backs up the settings that are about to change.
- Revert last import restores them in a single step, and purges the cache again.
- Only the most recent import can be reverted — a later import replaces the stored backup. Treat it as a safety net, not a version history.

Good to know

The importer only accepts settings it recognises. Anything unrecognised in the file is ignored, and every value is re-validated before it is stored — so an edited or corrupted file cannot introduce unexpected data into your site.

Note

Import replaces rather than merges. Settings absent from the file are left alone, but cookie categories and blocked scripts, when present, replace the existing sets in full. Files are most reliable between the same or nearby plugin versions.

22. Caching & Performance

The plugin is safe to run behind a page cache. That sounds like a small claim, and it is the single largest change in version 2.3.3.

What was wrong before

The banner, the script blocking and the consent signals were all built on the server from the visitor's consent cookie. A page cache stores one copy of a page and serves it to everybody, so whichever visitor happened to generate that copy had their consent baked into it.

The practical effect: the first visitor to accept everything caused a fully unblocked page to be stored, and every visitor served that copy afterwards got the trackers running whatever they had chosen themselves. Google and Microsoft were told those visitors had consented. And a single visitor with Global Privacy Control enabled could cause everyone afterwards to be treated as having opted out, suppressing marketing consent site-wide.

None of it was visible from the admin screens. The settings were correct, the banner appeared, and the blocking was not happening.

What happens now

Nothing that varies by visitor is written into the page. Every visitor receives an identical document with all non-necessary scripts and embeds held, a denied consent default, and no GPC state at all. Their own choice is applied in their browser — releasing scripts, updating the consent signals, reading their own GPC setting, and swapping the language if one is approved.

The page is therefore identical whoever generates it, which is precisely what makes it safe to cache.

Good to know

This also made the plugin faster on cached sites. The rewriting work now happens once per cache miss rather than once per visitor, and each blocked service is checked with a plain substring test before any pattern matching runs. A page with no third-party embeds costs roughly a single scan.

Purging on save

Saving your settings purges the page cache automatically, so a change to the banner shows up straight away instead of waiting for the cache to expire — which used to look exactly like the save had failed. This covers the settings screen, cookie categories, blocked scripts, the form integration message, Custom CSS, and both settings import and revert.

- SiteGround Speed Optimizer

- WP Rocket
- LiteSpeed Cache
- W3 Total Cache
- WP Super Cache
- WP Fastest Cache
- WP-Optimize
- Cache Enabler
- Breeze
- Nginx Helper
- WP Engine

What it deliberately does not touch

- **Your PHP opcode cache.** OPcache stores compiled PHP files and is only relevant when a file on disk changes, which saving a setting does not do.
- **Minified assets.** The banner stylesheet does not change when you save; its colours are emitted inline.
- **Your object cache.** Redis and Memcached hold the geolocation lookup cache, which is keyed per visitor address and expires on its own.

Note

If your host purges on its own schedule, or your agency controls purging from a deploy script, the behaviour can be turned off with the `mbr_cc_flush_caches` filter. There are also `mbr_cc_before_flush_caches` and `mbr_cc_flush_caches_after` actions for hooking your own cache layer in, and `mbr_cc_cache_ignored_options` for excluding particular settings.

One thing caching still affects

Regional banner wording is chosen while the page is built, so a cached page carries whichever region was resolved when it was stored. This is the one remaining place where a cache and this plugin interact awkwardly, and it is why section 24 still has an entry about the wrong region's banner appearing. Consent itself is unaffected — the blocking is correct for every visitor regardless.

23. CCPA and 'Do Not Sell or Share'

For visitors in California and other US states with similar laws, the plugin can display the required opt-out mechanism.

- An optional Do Not Sell or Share My Personal Information link is available.
- Selecting it records the visitor's opt-out and applies it to the relevant categories.
- Browser-level Global Privacy Control signals are honoured as a valid opt-out automatically.

24. Troubleshooting & FAQ

The banner does not appear

You have most likely already recorded a consent choice in your current browser. Test in a private / incognito window, or clear the plugin's stored consent for your site, and the banner will return.

Backslashes are multiplying in my banner text

This was a bug in versions before 2.3.3. Each time you saved, every quote or apostrophe gained more backslashes — one, then three, then seven, then fifteen. Updating to 2.3.3 fixes the cause and repairs the stored text automatically on the first admin page load afterwards. If you had quotes in your Custom CSS, that field is excluded from the automatic repair and needs correcting by hand under Settings > Advanced.

My YouTube or Vimeo embed plays without consent

If you run a performance plugin with a video lazy-load or facade option, this is almost certainly the cause and it is fixed in 2.3.3. Those plugins replace the embed with a poster image and build the real player in JavaScript on click, so before this release there was no embed in the page for the consent layer to hold. Update, purge your caches, and test again with cookies rejected — you should see the blocked-content placeholder in place of the video.

My banner changes are not showing on the front end

From version 2.3.3 the page cache is purged automatically when you save, so this should resolve itself. If a change still does not appear, clear your browser cache first — it sits outside anything the plugin can reach. Then confirm your caching plugin is one of those listed in section 22; if it is not, purge it manually and let me know which one you use so it can be added.

The wrong region's banner appears on some pages

This is almost always caching rather than detection. The banner is rendered on the server, so whichever region was resolved when a page was first cached is stored in that page's cached HTML and served to everyone until the cache is cleared. That is why one page can show the correct banner while another shows the wrong one.

Clear your caches in this order, and do not stop at the first two:

- Your page-cache plugin (for example WP Rocket).
- Your host or server cache (for example SiteGround's dynamic cache), and your PHP opcode cache if you have one.
- Your object cache — Redis or Memcached. This is the step most often missed. The plugin stores geolocation lookups as WordPress transients, and on hosts with a persistent object cache those live in Redis or Memcached rather than in the database, so they survive a page-cache purge and even a direct database query.

After clearing, load the page yourself from the region you expect, then clear the page cache once more so the corrected version is stored.

Tip

If the wrong region persists after all three layers are cleared, check that your server can reach your geolocation provider at all. If outbound requests are blocked or rate-limited, every lookup falls back to your default region. Switching provider — for example to Cloudflare headers, where available — removes the outbound call entirely.

My translated banner is still in English

Check three things in order. Automatic translation must be enabled under Settings; at least one language must be approved on the Translations screen; and the visitor's browser must be asking for a language you have approved. A language that is available but not approved is deliberately not served — see section 16. Strings you have rewritten yourself are also never translated, which is intentional.

Marketing cookies seem to be off for everyone

Before 2.3.3, a single visitor with Global Privacy Control enabled could cause every subsequent visitor on a cached site to be treated as having opted out. If your marketing tags stopped firing for no apparent reason and you run a page

cache, this is the likely explanation. Updating fixes it; purge your caches afterwards.

My site is never offered an update

Before version 2.3.2 the update manifest declared minimums of PHP 8.0 and WordPress 6.0, while the plugin itself supports PHP 7.4 and WordPress 5.8. The manifest is what decides whether an update is offered, so sites on those older versions were told no update was available. Install 2.3.2 or later by hand once, and automatic updates will work from then on.

Everyone sees the same region, or the wrong one, behind my CDN

Check Visitor IP Detection under Geolocation. The default, Automatic, believes Cloudflare's header only when the request genuinely came from a Cloudflare address. If you sit behind a different proxy or load balancer, set the mode to Trusted proxies and supply its addresses, otherwise every visitor appears to arrive from the proxy itself.

Scripts still load before consent

Check that the script is known to the plugin — run the scanner again and confirm it is listed and categorised. Hard-coded scripts placed directly in the theme may need to be added manually. Also confirm no other plugin is loading the script outside the consent layer.

My banner text is right in the admin but wrong on the site

If you run WPML or Polylang, this was the fault corrected in 2.3.2 — see section 16. In your default language the plugin's setting now wins, so updating should resolve it. If you had edited the default-language string in WPML's String Translation screen as a workaround, that edit is now overridden and the wording should be moved into the plugin's own settings.

The AI training section is missing from my privacy policy

The section only appears if you have enabled it under Advanced Consent, and the policy page must be regenerated after you change the setting. An existing policy page is not rewritten automatically — use the Regenerate button on the Dashboard, described in section 15.

Forms submit before consent is given

Confirm the form's required consent category is set under Form Builder Integration, and that the form plugin is one of the supported builders. Then test the full submit-block-accept-resubmit cycle in a private window.

An import did not bring everything across

Check the report shown after importing — it lists how many settings were applied and flags anything ignored. Policy page IDs, cached lookups, proxy settings, the ip-api.com key and the AI training disclosure are all excluded by design, so review those on the destination site. If the file came from a much newer plugin version, some newer settings may not be recognised; update the destination site and import again.

Translations are not showing

Ensure the visitor's browser language is one of the supported languages, and that your custom text has been translated through WPML or Polylang where you use them. Updating to the latest version also clears the WordPress 6.7 text-domain notice.

Does this plugin slow my site down?

The consent layer is lightweight and loads early so it can block trackers on the first view. If you also run a performance plugin that delays JavaScript, make sure the consent script is excluded from delay so it is ready before trackers attempt to fire.

25. Support, Feedback & Resources

Your feedback shapes the plugin. Bug reports are fixed quickly, and the best new features come from real users describing what they need — the import and export feature began exactly that way, and version 2.3.3 exists because someone took the time to report that their apostrophes kept multiplying.

Resource	Where
Plugin home	littlewebshack.com/mbr-cookie-consent/
Source & issues	github.com/HarbourBob/MBR-Cookie-Consent
Email	info@littlewebshack.com
More plugins & dev tools	littlewebshack.com

Whether you have a question, a bug to report, a feature idea, or simply want to say the plugin saved you a subscription — every message is read and valued. Together we are building the best consent manager for WordPress.

Good to know

MBR Cookie Consent is free and GPL-licensed. No upsells, no tracking, no vendor lock-in. © 2026 Robert Palmer · Little Web Shack · Built in Cleethorpes, UK.